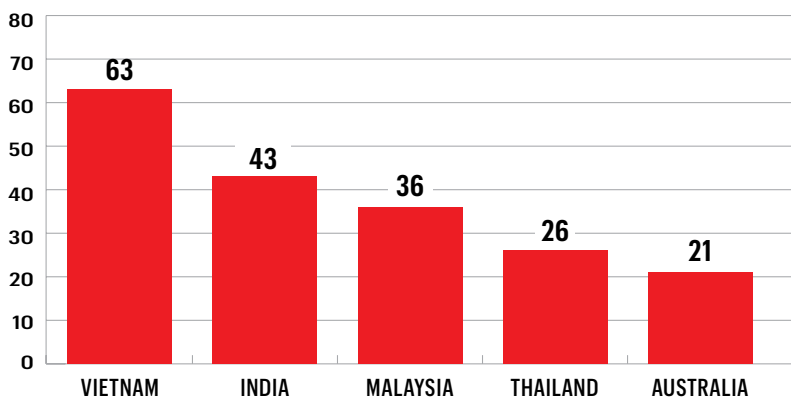




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COUNTRIES WITH BIGGEST INCREASE IN DOMESTIC AIRFARE SINCE 2019



NOTE FIGURES IN FIRST HALF OF 2024

SOURCE AIRPORTS COUNCIL INTERNATIONAL

capacity rises,” Paul says.

In India, though, domestic air traffic is projected to grow 7-10% this year. As per DGCA data, there was a 6.12% increase in total domestic air passengers to 161 million in 2024 from 152 million on 2023.

As the booking phase for the summer holiday season begins, airlines are offering attractive discounts to inspire early bookers.

“As a result, currently there is merely a 5-10% increase in fares for popular domestic destinations such as Kashmir, Leh, Andamans, and Chandigarh. From an international perspective, European destinations like Spain and Scandinavian cities—Copenhagen and Stockholm—are witnessing higher advance fares of 4-5%,” Indiver Rastogi, President & Group Head, Global Business Travel, Thomas Cook (India) and SOTC tells *BT*.

ISING EVENT TOURISM

A similar surge was seen during the British rock band Coldplay’s concert in Ahmedabad in January this year as well as during the Indian Premier League or during the ICC Men’s World Cup final, also held in Ahmedabad in 2023. According to the travel industry, concerts, religious gatherings, and global sports tournaments significantly influence travel patterns and result in a temporary spike in airfares.

“With event tourism witnessing a surge in demand, major events like the Mahakumbh or global music concerts like Coldplay lead to demand-supply constraints, with an understandable, though temporary, uptick in air pricing. But such fluctuations are typically limited to the event period,” Rastogi says.

With aspirations rising, the travel industry is witnessing an uptick in demand from Tier II and Tier III cities such as Bhubaneswar, Indore, Jaipur, and Lucknow, indicating a broader appetite beyond major metros. That, too, is adding pressure on existing capacity. **BT**

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